

Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

January 2026



£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



**St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley**
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

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Cover: Hergest Ridge : Tim Allen

Notes from the Curate

It was written in the stars!

It's the start of a New Year and I suspect many of us wonder what surprises this year will hold. Will it be a year of happiness, sadness or as is so often the case, a mixture of both. I remember in my late teens taking a keen interest in Horoscopes. Mystic Meg and Russel Grant (and other astrologers) would often have full page spreads in the newspapers at the start of the year to tell us what the future held. A very rough calculation determines that there are approximately 4 million other Cancerians in the UK, the idea that the brief predication in the paper could apply to all of us now seems highly unlikely.

Yet intelligent people do study the stars, or the cosmos as scientists call it. In 2011 Saul Perlmutter, Adam Riess and Brian Schmidt received the Noble prize for Physics for a discovery they made in 1998. These men and their teams studied distant supernova-exploding stars and discovered that the expansion of the universe was accelerating and not slowing down as previously thought. This discovery had profound implications. Scientists had thought that gravity was slowing the expansion of the universe which would potentially result in a cosmic crush. This new discovery showed that a new entity

any time soon).

Studying the stars helps scientists to map the evolution of the universe in an attempt to try and predict the future. *

This is not a new area of study. The earliest remnants of the Gospel of Matthew tell us that when Jesus was born in Bethlehem he was visited by wise men- a translation of the word Magi. They came from the East, to pay homage to a new King after seeing a star and they brought with them three gifts of Gold, Frankincense and Myrrh. These were expensive items, and we can therefore predict that the Magi were educated people, indeed there is evidence that Magi were present as astrologers and/or priests in the courts of the ancient Babylonian and Persian kings. The Magi were not kings; there were probably more than three and we don't know their names.

What we do know is that through studying the stars they predicted the birth of Jesus, a person who would be of great significance. By extension this means that the birth of Jesus was pre-planned because it was written in the stars at the start of creation. How mind blowing is that! God knew he would need to be present on Earth in human form to show us just how much he loved and care for us, to try and rescue us from ourselves. A definite moment of Epiphany.

*Ian Sample, Nobel prize for discovery that the universe is accelerating into the void, The Guardian, Tuesday 4th October 2011.

Phillipa



By extension this means that the birth of Jesus was pre-planned because it was written in the stars at the start of creation. How mind blowing is that!

(or force) called "dark energy" was at work gradually ripping the cosmos apart (this will take millions of years, it's not going to happen

From the Bishop of Hereford

January 12th is designated as Blue Monday, the most miserable of the year. The festivities of Christmas are a distant memory, and winter still holds us in its grip. A few valiant daffodils and snowdrops poking through the mud do little to elevate the mood. At least that is the contemporary narrative.

However, we Christians, especially in the Diocese of Hereford are entering into a year of celebration.

We have had three years to explore our central values of Christlikeness, prayerfulness and engagement and now we want to celebrate, not least because the diocese is 1350 years old this year. As Bishop of Hereford, it is an extraordinary thing to walk into the cathedral for a service passing a board that shows you have 105 predecessors in an unbroken line back to 676! Our diocese predates England and was carved out of a corner of the ancient kingdom of Mercia and the Romano-British kingdom of Archenfield. It is hard to see any connection between the wild, rural subsistence society of that time and the modern world. And yet our year will celebrate an unbroken thread of Christian faith, about the only thing that does link the ancient past to today. From the first Celtic saints like St. Dubricius who brought Christianity to this part of the world in the sixth century, to Putta our first Bishop, expelled from Rochester and finding a home here, to people like St. Aedfrith and St. Milburgha who linked this then obscure part of the world to wider Christendom. But

And yet our year will celebrate an unbroken thread of Christian faith, about the only thing that does link the ancient past to today.

We may feel we are struggling as a church today, but whether acknowledged or not much that is good in the modern world owes its origin to the Gospel

not just our founders. Christians are described by the Apostle Paul as Saints. The witness

of some remains through the centuries. For some there might be a stone memorial, but I doubt anyone will remember much about me as a Bishop in 50 years time when they walk past my name on the board. Over the last 1350 years the Gospel has advanced as much by ordinary people living it out in their homes, workplaces and communities as it has by the few preserved by history. That remains the case today. We would not have the healthcare system, education, good working conditions

in factories, the abolition of slavery and countless other benefits but for such Christian witness and activity. We may feel we are struggling as a church today, but whether acknowledged or not much that is good in the modern world

owes its origin to the Gospel. That is well worth celebrating.

+Richard

*The Rt Rev'd Richard Jackson
Bishop of Hereford*



St. Mary's Church, Kington

We hope that you have had a happy and peaceful Christmas and send you our very best wishes for 2026.

St Mary's was busy before Christmas with a variety of happenings.

Community shop

This raised £1,677 for the Friends of St Mary's, a fund which is used solely for the fabric of the church. Thank you to everyone who did anything to help with this successful result, and also to those who came to buy.

Beetle Drives

These continue to be very enjoyable and well attended. There will be no Beetle in January, but we look forward to seeing you all on Tuesday February 3rd 2026.

Memory Tree/Light up a Life service

The memory tree was alight in church every day in December, and over £250 was sent to St Michael's Hospice from the sale of stars, and donations given at the service.

Crib Festival

Nearly 50 cribs were displayed in church during December, and we do hope that many of you had the chance to visit and enjoy them. Perhaps some of you had tea and biscuits, and possibly cake at the weekends, sitting underneath one of our new heated haloes to keep warm.

January 2026

Several activities are already planned for January.

Saturday Jan. 17th. Let There be Light.

1.30pm to 3.30pm, with Christingle oranges and junk camels, followed by refreshments.



Wednesday Jan. 21st. Lego Club.

Saturday Jan. 31st. Scottish Churches, the ones Betjeman Forgot. An illustrated talk with refreshments afterwards, given by Richard Surman.

Watch out for posters for more details!

With every good wish for 2026,
Ann Edwards and Margaret Cooke
Churchwardens



– Kington Creations –

St Mary's Lego Club

Thousands of bricks, Lots of mini figures,
Loads of fun !

Wednesday 21st January

3:30pm – 5:00pm

St Marys Church Kington

Young children to be accompanied
by an adult please

Refreshments available
legoclub.kington@gmail.com

Having fun creating together

St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

With no current church news (mid-December), I hope the article below will be of interest.

Susan Maiden

Mrs Bertha Morgan (Huntington School Headmistress 1911 - 1953):

Following the article, in the October 2024 Parish News, on the closure of Huntington School in 1953, Lynn (a descendant of the Turner family) contacted me to say she had a booklet entitled "Schoolmistress at Huntington – The Life of Bertha Morgan" by Hilda Kendall and would I like to borrow it. The booklet was produced to mark the school's bicentenary. An article in The Hereford Times on the 25th April 1991, detailed the plans for the forthcoming weekend of celebrations on the 1st and 2nd June 1991.

Extracts taken from the booklet:

Huntington School was founded in 1791 by Edward Goff, who was born in Huntington in 1738, the son of a farm labourer. Unable to afford school fees, Edward was uneducated. Unhappy with farm work, aged 25, Edward walked 150 miles to London finding a job as a coal heaver by the River Thames. Working his way up he eventually ran the business, becoming sole proprietor. Edward taught himself to read but could only write his name. Edward Goff died in 1813 and is buried in an unmarked grave in Hay (according to his wishes). He left £4,000 to relatives/friends, £4,310 to be distributed to the sick/poor through various societies. Huntington School, in addition to former grants/endowments, received £1,000. The remainder, almost £15,000, was to be used to establish Day Schools for the benefit of poor children.

Huntington was the first of Goff's schools to be built, with 22 others following from 1815 until 1876 in Herefordshire, Worcestershire, Monmouthshire, Gloucestershire, Shropshire



and Radnor. Only one school has maintained the name of Goff – Gorsley Goff's Church of England Primary School, established in 1821.

Rev. D J Morgan - Minister Huntington Congregational Church for 37 years (1911 – 1949)

Mrs Bertha Morgan – Headmistress at Huntington School for 42 years (from 1911 until 1953)

Daughters - Mrs Dorothy Alexander (born 1918) and Dr. Hilda Kendall (born 1920)

Mrs Bertha Morgan (nee Lloyd):

Bertha was the eldest of three daughters and five sons to her parents – John Henry Lloyd and Elizabeth Maria Lloyd (nee Jones). John Henry Lloyd was appointed Headmaster at Huntington School in 1875. Elizabeth Maria Lloyd was the daughter of Rev. William Jones, who was the Minister at Huntington Congregational Church (1861 – 1879).

20 August 1876 – Born at Huntington School

1880 – 1892 – Pupil - Huntington School

1892 – 1896 – Pupil Teacher - Huntington School

1896 – 1898 – (Queen's Scholarship) - Student

at Mason College, Birmingham University
(gaining a Double First)

1896 – 1902 – Teacher – Small Heath,
Birmingham

1902 – 1907 – Headteacher - Peterchurch

As Bertha's father's health was deteriorating,
she returned to Huntington.

1907 – 1911 – Assistant Teacher – Huntington
School

1911 – 1953 – Headmistress – Huntington
School

Article to be continued in February 2026
Parish News.

*Reference from "Schoolmistress at Huntington
– The Life of Bertha Morgan" by Hilda
Kendall – ISBN 0 9517478 0 0*



St. Peter's Church Titley

Readers

Sunday 4th January Elizabeth

Sunday 18th January Judith.

"Let there be Light"

Our most grateful thanks are extended to
Harry King, who has installed a new lamp
standard which he made for the village
to replace the rotten wooden one. The
church path will be illuminated again.

At the same time, in time for the
birthday memory of Phyllis Lewis the church
is now lit from 5pm to 9pm each evening.
During these dark nights it is so nice to see
the church shining out to all who pass by.

Village Lunch and Carol Service.

Many thanks are extended to Helen Boley
for organising the Village Christmas Lunch.
It was a lovely community time and enjoyed
by all who attended. To round the day off
we all went to church for our carol service.
Many thanks to all the ladies who provided
the homemade cakes we all enjoyed after the
service.

On behalf of our vicar Sally, and all PCC, a
very happy new year to everyone.

Many thanks

Dick

PARISH NEWS PRICES FOR 2026

Sale Prices

The new prices for copies of the Kington,
Huntington and Titley Parish News are:

Single copies £1. This is unchanged.

Subscription for the year: £10. An increase
but still cheaper than single copies.

— Advertising

The advertising year is from April to
March, 12 Copies. The new prices are:

Full page: £340

Half page: £190

Quarter page: £100

Eighth page: £50

Based on an A5 page size.

Further information from Nick:
st.marys.kington.treasurer@gmail.com,
01544 230805

Kington Parishes: January 2026

Sunday, 4th Epiphany

Isaiah 60:1-6, Psalm 72:10-15, Ephesians 3:1-12, Matthew 2:1-12

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Holy Communion:*	Kington
11.30am:	Holy Communion:	Kinnerton
6.00pm:	Junior Praise:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Praise and Prayer Evening:	Kington

Sunday, 11th Baptism of Christ

Isaiah 42:1-9, Psalm 29, Acts 10:34-43, Matthew 3:13-end

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Huntington
10.00am:	Holy Communion:*	Kington
11.30am:	Holy Eucharist:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Kinnerton

Sunday, 18th Epiphany 2

Isaiah 49:1-7, Psalm 40:1-12, 1 Corinthians 1:1-9, John 1:29-42

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Morning Praise:*	Kington
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Old Radnor

Sunday, 25th Epiphany 3

Isaiah 9: 1-14, Psalm 27: 1,4-12, 1 Corinthians 1:10-18, Matthew 4 12-23

10.00am:	Holy Eucharist:*	Kington
4.00pm:	Plough Sunday Service:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Evensong:	Huntington

*** Live streamed services**

January

Please get in touch if your group is within a 10 mile radius of Kington and would like to be added to a small waiting list who will be offered any vacancies as they arise

Email: kingtoncommunityshop@outlook.com

Best wishes

Richie Cotterill

07777 661252

Kington & District Community Shop

KINGTON
&
DISTRICT
Community
Shop

07-Jan: Community Shop Self-Fundraising

14-Jan: St. Mary's PCC

21-Jan: Friends of Radnor Valley School.

28-Jan: Friends of Gladestry School - FROGS

Forthcoming Activities for Children and Families at St Mary's

17/01/26 Let there be Light!

An afternoon of craft activity including Christingle oranges, junk camels and sparkling stars with refreshments. St Mary's Church, 1:30 pm with refreshments afterwards.

21/01/26 Lego Club

St Mary's Church, 3.30pm

17/02/26. Pancakes galore Holiday Club

Children under 5 must be accompanied. Booking essential £5 per child, concessions available. St Mary's Church, 1:30-4pm with refreshments afterwards

18/02/26 Lego Club

St Mary's Church, 3.30pm

08/03/26 Wild Church.

Come and explore the great outdoors using proven forest school techniques. 2:30-4.00pm
(location to be confirmed)

18/03/26 Lego Club

St Mary's Church, 3.30pm

03/04/26 Good Friday Holiday Club

Children under 5 must be accompanied. Booking essential £5 per child, concessions available. St Mary's Church, 9:30-11.30 with refreshments afterwards

12/04/26 Wild Church

Come and explore the great outdoors using proven forest school techniques. 2:30-4.00pm
(location to be confirmed)

Stay and Play

Every Tuesday during term time from 13th January, 9:15-10:45am at
the Parish Hall (parking at rear).

Stories, songs, toys, craft and refreshments for parents/ carers and
children 0-3.

Why not come and have some fun!

New!



Starting 13th January

Stay and Play

Baby & Toddler Group

**For parents and carers with
children aged 0-3, no booking
required.**

St Mary's Parish Hall

(parking at rear)

Tuesdays 9:15-10:45

Term Time Only



**Light refreshments, stories and
songs, lots of toys, themed activities.**

**Group provided by St Mary's Kington PCC. Suggested
donation £2**

Reader Writes

Many spent 2025 worrying about President Trump. His speeches might have been entertaining before more sober reflection finds them worrying. A weekend in October saw 7 million people in the 50 US states at 2700 No Kings events. This was democracy in action! It is alleged by protestors that their president was conducting government like a Caesar or medieval king. This is very new for an American president. Sue me for a billion dollars, but perhaps they have a point.

So where was the Church in all this? Did Christians have something to say, or did they subscribe to the idea that a solid wall should separate church from politics? I was moved to see that Episcopalians and Presbyterians turned out in numbers to support No Kings. Christian leaders, including 3 Catholic bishops, have condemned the administration's harsh treatment of immigrants, native Americans and the many who live in limbo waiting for visas. At the same time it is acknowledged that what is called the Evangelical church in the US is mostly Republican leaning.

Whilst the American presidency can't be compared with Europe's Nazis in the 1930s, we should none-the-less remind ourselves of the lessons in Europe we daren't forget. In her memoir Christabel Bielenberg, an Irish woman, describes her war years in Germany. She married a Hamburg lawyer in 1934, and joined him in Hamburg. As the Nazis' ambitions developed, the Bielenbergs moved to Berlin. Surely the generals won't let him do it, they kept arguing (and hoping). Surely in Berlin there will be a resistance movement they could join? Surely there would be

likeminded citizens who were as concerned as they. But no, of the several known plots to assassinate Hitler, none succeeded.

That was the Germany and the Germans we love. It wouldn't happen in Britain of course, would it? A German acquaintance working in the City told me "Germans are the only ones allowed to be fascists these days." (And that surprised me; is irony now also allowed in Germany?) So it is salutary to remember the Christian pastor, Dietrich Bonhoeffer, who courageously spoke out against fascism. He had studied and worked in Britain and the US, and was prominent in his opposition to that large part of the church in Germany that

Christians must be alert to the dangers to democracy, and to justice and human rights

supported Hitler. At the same time there were other parts of the German speaking church, uncompromisingly opposed to the National Socialists, that suffered persecution. Bonhoeffer himself was arrested in 1943 and hung in April 1945.

We don't have to hunt for fascism; there is plenty of it, and it's dangerously close with Putin's war in Ukraine. Christians must be alert to the dangers to democracy, and to justice and human rights; these "rights" are too easily taken for granted. We are called to speak truth to power, usually against the prevailing grain of society. Jesus faced opposition from the governing temple priesthood. Think of the woman "caught in adultery"; he shamed them in their hypocrisy. "Let him who is without sin be the first to throw a stone"; one by one they left. Pastor Bonhoeffer, and indeed the Bielenbergs, were motivated by Christian justice, and were prepared to pay a high price for it. In a new year we may cast a baleful eye on old dangers, but there are new challenges requiring courage and prayer.

Robert MacCurrach

Caring for God's Acre

Thinking about Carbon

It seems fitting, as we start a new year to focus on larger issues, trying to make positive changes to tackle the global crises of climate change and biodiversity loss. For those of you who care for our churchyards, chapel yards and cemeteries there is much you can do for wildlife and hopefully these monthly articles have already inspired you to take some steps already. But how climate change and carbon? Is there anything we can do about that on a local level?

Well, yes there is, for those of us who manage a piece of land, whether it's our own garden or the local burial ground there is a great deal that we can do.

Firstly, care for your trees. Trees and shrubs store carbon in wood, be it the trunk, branches or roots. Trees store more carbon than other plants owing to their size and long lifespan. Hedges too can store carbon for a long time. Many churchyards and cemeteries contain ancient trees as well as trees planted in Victorian times, often conifers with a shorter lifespan as well as the longer-lived native broadleaves. These conifers may be coming toward the end of their life so keep an eye on them, carry out an annual inspection using The Caring for God's Acre sheet on inspecting trees as well as having professional surveys by a skilled arborist. The life of a tree can be prolonged by care and prompt action as problems arise, (which can save money too). Perhaps you can think about planting young trees to replace those nearing the end of their lives. Young trees grow quickly, laying down carbon-based wood as they do so.

Secondly, think about your grassland. Rather surprisingly grassland is actually great at storing carbon. Whilst carbon is stored in the visible, above ground plants it is within the soil that most if held in fact it is estimated that up to 30% of the earth's carbon is stored



in grassland soil.

Soil carbon comes from decomposing plants, animals and fungi. When things die, they are broken down and used as food by insects, worms and other invertebrates, fungi, bacteria and other microbes. Whilst some carbon dioxide is released most carbon is incorporated into the soil. The more mature the soil, the better for carbon storage. A mature, complex, undisturbed soil has a wide range of life within its soil, all of which contain carbon. Churchyard, chapel yard and cemetery grassland are usually mature and full of different grasses, flowering plants, fungi and lichens.

What about the length of the grass, does that have an effect? Yes it does, taller grassland rather than short lawn has a deeper zone of active soil due to deeper plant roots. This active soil is full of carbon-based life.

So look at your local churchyard with new eyes, seeing it as a carbon store and seeing if you can improve this. Care for your trees, plant replacements and when trees need to be felled try to leave some deadwood on site. Is there scope to increase the grass length in some areas to increase the depth of active, carbon-rich soil? Finally, can you reduce the use of petrol machines such as lawn mowers and strimmers replacing with electric ones or maybe using them less often.

All of these actions will benefit wildlife too so it really is doubly worthwhile.

Harriet Carty

Diocesan Churchyard Environmental Advisor

God by Numbers

I is for one God. Having got to Z is for Zacchaeus in the A to Z of God, we thought we should do God by numbers. We'll go for 12 for this year, and with your help we might try another 12, or perhaps start an A to Z of the Church. For now it is one for one God. So no pantheism, holy icons, multiple gods or dumb idols.

The oneness of the sovereign God, our Creator, is fundamental to Christian faith and theology. Jesus taught that I and my Father are one (Jn10:30). Paul, in his letter to the Ephesians, makes this clear and vital (Eph4:5-6). There is one Lord, one faith, one baptism, one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in all. Jesus taught us to pray "Our Father in heavenyour will be done." Our One God wills for meaningful relationship with each one of us, to bring us back to union, oneness with himself. And this union is to be reflected by us in the Church as a testimony in the world; by one Spirit we are many members in one body.

According to John's Gospel chapter 17, Jesus prays what has become known as the High Priestly Prayer. The temple would no longer be needed; the Levitical priesthood was about to be redundant. Jesus himself was to become the one sacrifice sufficient for all mankind. He prays to his Father in heaven. Holy Father, keep them in your name, which you have given me, that they may be one, even as we are one. Jesus also prays that his followers may be one, just as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be in us so that the world may believe that you have sent me. This oneness is essential to the Father's relationship with his Son, Jesus, and essential to our relationship with our one God.

As the numbers increase, this might get simpler! Or will it?

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns
(Any bright ideas, let us know!)

Man's Disappointments are God's Appointments

Three things are definitely true. God is good, God loves you and God is in control.

Do not allow your mind to doubt God's goodness in any circumstance.

And we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him, who have been called according to his purpose. For those God foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters. And those he predestined, he also called; those he called, he also justified; those he justified, he also glorified.

Romans 8:28-30

Look back on your life and consider your disappointments. How many times has God used those for good? How many times has God not granted your wishes or not answered your prayers for your own good? Has God taken you to difficult places? How has that changed you? Was it for your good?

Maybe you're in a difficult place now. God has promised never to leave or forsake you. He has not promised that there will be no trials, but he has promised that he will be with you in those trials.

*'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you;
I have summoned you by name; you are mine.
When you pass through the waters,
I will be with you;
and when you pass through the rivers,
they will not sweep over you.
When you walk through the fire,
you will not be burned;
the flames will not set you ablaze.
For I am the Lord your God,
the Holy One of Israel, your Saviour;
Greg Wright*

MONTHLY MUSINGS

I've been musing this month about *silence*. What a God given gift that is, and how commonly spurned, is that real, penetrative, proactive silence that, if permitted and welcomed, invades one's very being.

Personally, I find that's available, in this noisy world, mostly in some special places. During covid, for example, Giles and I would, every Monday morning, take our coffee to the tables by the pond in Park Wood, where the stillness and silence is often almost palpable, just the whispering of the tall trees above and the gentle song of that overflowing pool. And what's more, even that pool's message was a parable: that water was the love of God filling each of us to overflowing, enabling us likewise to overflow in love for others.

As the saying goes, We love because He first loved us. Very seldom were we interrupted, and even if someone did walk past with a dog, they were probably plugged in to some muzak and oblivious of their surroundings!

And that introduces us to one of the most horrid enemies of silence which, coincidentally(?) entered the world the same year as I did! MUZAK. Perhaps if that had been widely known I might have been christened Muzak! Horrendous thought! Instead, a Company, was founded in America to market background 'music' (trademarked Muzak) specially produced to provide

accompaniment or background atmosphere, which not everyone appreciates. My big brother John kept a number of special cards to leave, for example, in restaurants where intrusive muzak was a nuisance. The cards were marketed, I believe, by a group called Pipedown some thirty years ago. There's plenty of information about all this online. You can see how the whole thing took off and has spread since its beginning in America long ago. Nowadays you can hardly avoid the racket. What irks me personally is the way it interferes in most of the lovely documentaries Emma finds for us to watch on television, distracting me from so much wonderful visual beauty by butting in and out whenever there might be a bit of silence.

For most folk, alas, Christmas is all over by 27th December, and the shops are full of Easter eggs. But not so. On the first day of Christmas my true love said to me begins the old song, reminding us that even now, in the early days of January it's still Christmas! There are officially 12 days of Christmas. It's a feast to be celebrated with carols and festivals and parties bringing the community together with love and generosity; plenty of joyful noise and happiness and family get togetherness which we would hope shall not all end even on January 6th.

Denis

IMPORTANT MESSAGE

Please note that the deadline for the March edition of Kington Parish News will be **Sunday February 1st**. The editors have a very tight deadline to get the magazine to the printers and anything arriving after the 1st will be held over for the April edition.

May we also ask that any submissions should be 500 words MAXIMUM for all editions. We have to juggle so many items – which is great, but even exceeding the words count by 20 words means someone else's copy may not be able to be fitted. Please do not be offended if copy that exceeds the 500-word count is returned for pruning!!

Thanks for your continued support and cooperation. Craig and David

Do you love the church on the hill?

St Mary's Parish Church has stood near to the castle mound for about 800 years, and it would be a fine thing to think that it could stand for another 800!

For many years now the Friends have been helping to preserve and improve our very beautiful and ancient church building. Although there is no organisation now running the Friends, the bank account still exists. Donations to the account are restricted to ensuring the church building continues to grace our town. This appeals to those who have any faith or none but appreciate the glories of medieval architecture.

In addition to the usual church services St Mary's offers several benefits to the town. There is always free DiY hot and cold drinks for passing walkers. There are often concerts by local and less local musicians. Art exhibitions are hosted from time to time.

The current big project is the installation of the new heating system. This is going on apace with financial help from the Friends and will mean that the heating can, at last, become carbon free and will no longer contribute to the instability of our weather.

Thanks go to all who have worked for the Friends in the past and have donated generously.

If you would like more information, please contact Nick Cooke at st.marys.kington.treasurer@gmail.com 01544 230805. Bank account for donations: Friends of St. Marys, 20-39-64, 10787434. Cheques made payable to "The Friends of St. Mary's" or cash donations clearly marked "Friends of St. Mary's" also welcome. Please drop them through my door (25 Church Str.)

Nick Cooke.

Book Review

Wardrobes and Rings – Through Lenten Lands with the Inklings

By Julia Golding, Malcolm Guite, and Simon Horobin, Canterbury Press, £12.99

Drawing on the work of C.S. Lewis and J.R.R. Tolkien, as well as friends of the Inklings such as Dorothy Sayers and T.S. Eliot, this book explores through their eyes a faith which is tinged with seriousness, creativity and joy. Using their fiction, poetry, and essays, the book offers daily readings and reflections on the cross and resurrection, helping you to rediscover Lent through the lens of imagination-infused faith.

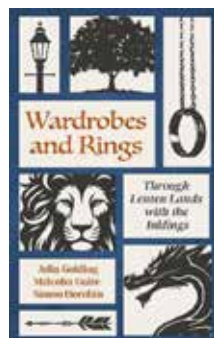


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With collections from your property, our new fortnightly garden waste collection service means you can spend less time transporting waste and more time relaxing in your outdoor space.

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The service will replace the current green garden waste sack sales.



Sign up now at
www.herefordshire.gov.uk/recycling

Not a Proper Gardener (Part 60)

The first half of Autumn this year was especially dark and, apart from one week of clear skies and light frosts, sunless and mild, as my solar panels confirm. Rainfall was moderate and only on one day was there a light fall of snow. Strangely this was on the same date as last year's. But even when the sun shines our vegetable area, being on the north side of the house, is mainly in the shade. Nevertheless, Emma continues to harvest some good, healthy food: salads, root crops like beetroot and carrots, tomatoes ripening indoors, kale; and we have plenty of fruit, both fresh and preserved.

The birds have been enjoying all the seed heads left for them: evening primrose, clematis, old man's beard (better shave before I'm discovered!). They've about finished the sunflowers, and Emma's planted up the outdoor pots with pretty little hardy flowers for the winter, mostly pansies and violas, while Giles has been putting away buckets, water cans and so on, not needed for the winter.

We thought we were probably losing the hedgehogs to winter hibernation – plenty of appropriate places in our jungle – but, lo and behold, one mid- morning recently, a little one came nosing hungrily round in the yard. Spotted by Emma it thankfully has been turning up regularly for a handful of calci worms, doubtless hoping to stock up enough to survive the winter. One day a couple of blackbirds, bemused by the appearance of this strange beast, cautiously drew closer, hoping to steal a worm or two. Eventually one risked a successful dart forward, much to the disgust of the other, which started a conflict. The hedgehog seemed not to care tuppence!

Emma has been starting to clear around the pond which, when I constructed it 25 years ago had a miniature water-lily and was fitted with a fountain driven by a solar panel. It's overshadowed by a holly bush, now much



too large and Emma has been cutting off twigs bearing berries. These she put out in a barrow for anyone to help themselves. Odd bits of rubbish she is finding by and in the water, including a frightening object Giles must have made in pottery somewhere and a giant pretend frog that was supposed to croak whenever someone walked past it. Heaven knows where that came from!

I'm afraid I'm not able to do as much as I used to in the garden now, but I've little excuse for having still not sown those winter broad beans in their coir pots. I suppose that, because on the packet it says Sow: Oct-Feb, it's taken a back seat in my list of things urgent to be done!

Happy gardening, Denis.

KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

Come and enjoy a 2-course meal
in a friendly environment with
other local seniors at:

Kington Parish Hall

(HR5 3AG)

at 12:30 p.m.

Cost is £6

We meet on the
3rd Wednesday of each month.

Next lunch is on 21st January

Contact: Rose 01544 230174

News From the Museum

The Foundry

I noticed a metal rail running alongside the pavement in Duke Street, when all the other kerbs were made of cement. Enquiring it turns out it was made by the Foundry in Kington and most of Kington kerbs were iron. The Meredith family owned The Foundry. In 1739 Richard was a Wool stapler and Trader. Marrying Elizabeth Miles, whose father was an Ironmonger of Kington, on his death, Richard inherited the business, which he ran alongside his other businesses. Setting up a small blacksmith's Shop, workshop and built a warehouse at lower Cross on the site of the old pig market (now the Burton) very successfully. On his death this business passed to his nephew John Meredith.

1820 John bought buildings at Sunset, diverting the water from the back brook for a wheel to be installed to provide power for the hammer and bellows for his new Foundry. John also built ten cottages named Nail row (Sunset Cottages) for his workers with eight forges on site for nails to be made. Of course we know of the explosion of the gun powder and ammunition store behind the Oxford Arms frightening and blowing out windows on Bradnor Hill Hill, and Presteign.

With the expansion of his business, John needed experienced workers, which came from Wolverhampton to help make kitchen ranges, ploughs, water pumps, wheels and other agricultural cast iron objects. John was joined by sons John Junior and James. By 1866 James inherited the business, advertising it for sale but it failed to sell. By 1882, 135 men and boys worked in the Foundry, making it the largest employer in Kington. The Foundry used electricity. 1895 Alfred Jones, Railway Tavern, ordered bolts,

hinges, ball tap, cistern, lead pipe and two copper closet hoppers, lined with lead of course.

James invested in the Brecon to Eardisley Tram Line besides buying Land, establishing a bank. James bought Butts meadow with the income he set up a Charity giving 80 loaves of bread, to 80 families, twice a month to those who could not manage a household, but not paupers, administered by the Vicar. This charity was eventually part of Kington United Charities. James looked after his workers giving them a half day holiday, but whether he provided the leather hats worn in the Foundry I do not know.

James invested in many businesses in and around Kington. Henry followed James, who carried on the Foundry expanding its range of goods as new inventions were discovered. By 1901 Messrs Alexander & Duncan of Leominster bought the business, ceasing in 1927 to operate as a Foundry.

The Meredith family is very large with members scattered across the world, each with a story to tell. Records show they even paid taxes to Richard 11. It is recorded that John Dee, Confidant and Astrologer to Queen Elizabeth 1 is a member of this illustrious family. Farming was another occupation the family was carrying out as descendants to day continue to do so in this area.

A very talented family whose businesses included (Henry) Drapers, Linen woollen Silk Mercer including rugs, chintzes and Moreens to Blacksmiths, farmers, businessmen and investors in the future.

Wendy Jones

From Lady Hawkins School

Allan Lloyd suggests that this story, by Sara in year 8, although not specifically for the New Year, makes a good follow on from last month's piece...As Sara herself concludes: "Christmas magic lives wherever kindness begins."

THE SNOWFLAKE SECRET

Snow shimmered silently over Silverpine Village, blanketing every rooftop in a dazzling diamond dust. The air was crisp with Christmas cheer, and every window winked with a warm golden glow. Children's laughter danced through the drifting flakes as they built snowfolk and whispered wishes into the winter wind.

At the edge of town stood Evergreen Cottage, home to a kind but curious girl named Anne Candelwick. Anne loved Christmas more than cocoa loves marshmallows. But this year was... different. The star atop the town's Christmas tree had vanished! Without it, the lights flickered faintly, and the songs sounded slightly sad.

Determined to save the season, Anne bundled in her crimson coat and followed the footprints of frost into the Whispering Woods. The trees twinkled as though telling secrets, their branches bowing under the burden of sparkling snow.

Suddenly – whoosh! - a swirl of silver light swooped past her! Out fluttered a tiny figure, wings shimmering like sugared snowflakes.

"Who are you?" Anne gasped.

"I'm Flurry, Keeper of Christmas Wishes," the fairy giggled, her voice like sleigh bells in moonlight. "The Star of Spirit was stolen by a greedy goblin called Grumblegruff! Without it, Christmas can't shine."

Anne stepped forward. "Christmas isn't about keeping – it's about giving."

Her words echoed softly, and something magical stirred. The star began to sparkle more brightly, reflecting Anne's courage and kindness. With a final shimmer, it floated from Grumblegruff's claws, and back into the sky, settling atop the Silverpine tree once more.

The forest filled with light so lovely it looked like heaven had opened its heart. Snowflakes spun like tiny dancers, bells chimed from unseen towers, and even Grumblegruff's frown melted into a smile.

Back in town, the villagers gasped as the star reignited the night in glorious gold. Anne and Flurry watched, hand in hand, as the first Christmastide snow began to fall.

And if you listen closely – beneath the bells and the laughter – you might still hear the faint flutter of Flurry's wings, whispering through the winter wind.

"Christmas magic lives wherever kindness begins."

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Herefordshire Libraries

Home Delivery Service

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For more information or to join please visit our website or telephone 01432 260645



Easy Sudoku

3		9		8			2	
	2	6		7	4		9	
7			6				8	
			7	2		5		
	8			3			4	
		7		1	5			
	3				7			1
	7		1	4		8	6	
	1			5		4		9

Intermediate Sudoku

		6					9	
1	5		9	8				
4			6	5				8
6	4	3				9		
		7				8	3	1
5				3	2			9
				4	9		5	6
	2					3		

Answers on page 24

KINGTON TOWN COUNCIL UPDATE



First of all, may I, on behalf of your Town Council, wish you all a very happy and prosperous NEW YEAR. As we move from 2025 to 2026 let us face it with optimism and in hope that things will be better for us all in the year ahead.

In the last council report, Cllr Martin Woolford told you of the Council's plan to introduce a 20MPH zone throughout Kington. Many people I have spoken to have expressed agreement with this idea, as have the two schools. But it would help us to make the case if we have your views expressed in response to Martins request. He asked that you would send a simple '20Yes' or '20No' message, to him at cllr.m.woolford@kingtontowncouncil.gov.uk, which will be immediately deleted after receipt.

We are all pleased to see the footpath through the Recreation Ground repaired. Though possibly you couldn't tell, as it was soon covered in a blanket of leaves. Talking of leaves, many thanks to all those who joined with the Chamber of Trade in the litter pick on 23rd November. It has made a huge difference and was just in time for the wonderful Christmas Light Switch On.

We have so much to be proud of in Kington.

The wonderful countryside around us, the great variety of shops and organisations which make Kington such a great place to live. But most of all, I think it is the real sense of community we have: people looking out for each other; sharing a smile and a kindly comment as they pass someone in the street; the huge numbers of people who volunteer to help in the many organisations and events taking place – all that makes Kington so special.

Most notably, I would like to highlight those who, organise and volunteer in any way to support KINGTON WALKS, A very worthy recipient of the King's Award for Voluntary Service. What an achievement- one of which we can all be rightly proud.

We are very good at putting on big events here: the Vintage Show, Food Festivals, Walking Festivals, art exhibitions and by no means the least, the marvellous Kington Show. This year, we will really be put to the test as we will, for the first time, host the Armed Forces Day celebration for the County. This takes place on Saturday 27th June- a date for your diaries. The event will start at Lady Hawkins School at 11am and then proceed to the Recreation Ground for the celebrations and fun. More details in the months ahead.

Have fun!

*Cllr Philip J.G. Sell
Mayor of Kington*

Kington Parish Hall for Hire!!

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p.s.halcrow@gmail.com*

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Lady Hawkins' Community Leisure Centre

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Saturday 21st Feb at 2:30

Adults ~ £10 Under 18s ~ £5

Tickets from The Burton
or ticketsource.co.uk/kados

kingtonoperatic.co.uk

From Tennyson's poem 'In Memoriam'

*Ring out, wild bells, to the wild sky,
The flying cloud, the frosty light:
The year is dying in the night,
Ring out, wild bells, and let him die*

*Ring out the old, ring in the new,
Ring happy bells across the snow
The year is going, let him go,
Ring out the false, ring in the true.*

*And rise, a moon, from yonder down,
Til over down and over dale
All night the shining vapour sail
And pass the silent-lighted town.*

It was our family custom to welcome in the new year with a toast wishing good health, happiness and prosperity to family and friends. Then to look back over the past year, counting our blessings and acknowledging our failings, making new year resolutions for the year ahead. A good condition that I hope we can keep.

We need at this time, to take stock of our lives, to look forward with courage and hope for the future.

Wishing you a Happy and Prosperous New Year.

Tony Jardine

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Wordsearch for January 2026



6th January brings **Epiphany** - the visit of the Wise Men to the baby Jesus. Matthew calls them 'Magi', the name of an ancient priestly caste from Persia. Early church tradition says there were three: Balthasar, Caspar and Melchior. As for their gifts? Gold is a symbol of wisdom and wealth, incense is a symbol of worship and sacrifice, and myrrh is a symbol of healing - and even embalming. Jesus challenged and set aright the way in which the world handled all three of these things.

Epiphany

Visit

Wise

Men

Magi

Priestly

Persia

Balthasar

Caspar

Melchior

Gold

Wealth

Wisdom

Incense

Worship

Sacrifice

Myrrh

Symbol

Healing

Embalming

Ancient

Gifts

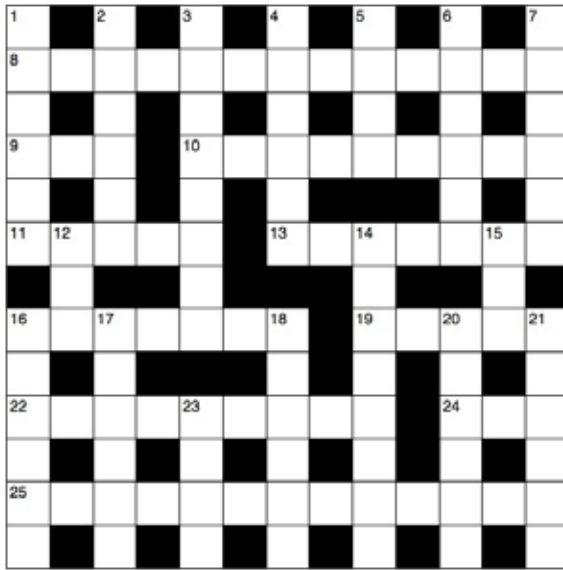
Tradition

Challenged

World

Please see page 24 for answers

January Crossword



Across

- 8 How the Abyss (NIV) is described in the Authorized Version (Revelation 9:1) (10,3)
- 9 Frozen water (Ezekiel 1:22) (3)
- 10 The Ten Commandments (9)
- 11 In Roman Catholic theology, neither heaven nor hell (5)
- 13 Des cons (anag.) (7)
- 16 'Though [your sins] are red as — , they shall be like wool' (Isaiah 1:18) (7)
- 19 Keen (Romans 1:15) (5)
- 22 Repugnant, loathsome (Jeremiah 24:9) (9)
- 24 Drink like an animal (Judges 7:5) (3)
- 25 First and last (Revelation 22:13) (5,3,5)

Down

- 1 Father of Ahi, a Gadite (1 Chronicles 5:15) (6)
- 2 Where David found the stone with which he killed Goliath (1 Samuel 17:40) (6)
- 3 'Hour by hour fresh lips are making thy — doings heard on high' (8)
- 4 'And there were shepherds living out in the fields near by, keeping watch over their — at night' (Luke 2:8) (6)
- 5 United Society for Christian Literature (1,1,1,1)
- 6 'If he refuses to listen even to the church, treat him as you would — — or a tax collector' (Matthew 18:17) (1,5)
- 7 Where Paul was taken when things became difficult for him in Berea (Acts 17:15) (6)
- 12 Istituto per le Opere di Religione (Vatican Bank) (1,1,1)
- 14 'Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new — ; the old has gone, the new has come!' (2 Corinthians 5:17) (8)
- 15 Used to colour ram skins red for use in the tabernacle (Exodus 25:5) (3)
- 16 Vat car (anag.) (6)
- 17 'Be joyful — — , patient in affliction, faithful in prayer' (Romans 12:12) (6)
- 18 'The parts that are unpresentable are treated with special modesty, while our presentable parts — — special treatment' (1 Corinthians 12:23) (4,2)
- 20 Ancient rowing boat (Isaiah 33:21) (6)
- 21 Say again (2 Corinthians 11:16) (6)
- 23 What Jesus did in the synagogue in Nazareth after he stood up (Luke 4:16) (4)

Please see page 24 for answers

OAK | Open Arms Kington January events



Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kington, October 2025.

Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).

Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.

JANUARY 2026

Wednesday 7th January, 10am-12.30pm. Sunflower Social at Places of Welcome. A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Wednesday 14th January, 10am-12.30pm. Dementia Matters at Places of Welcome. Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Saturday 24th January, from 6pm. Burns Night at The Oxford. We'll have live music to lighten the January gloom, more details to follow. Check our website and socials for the latest updates.

Regular opening hours in January:

Places of Welcome at The Oxford Arms, every Wednesday morning in January, 10am-12.30pm

OAK | Open Arms Kington CiC

www.openarmskington.co.uk

comms@openarmskington.co.uk

Brilley Flicks in the Sticks

Thursday 1st January at 7.30: The Ballad of Wallis Island (12A), £5

Estranged folk band duo Herb and Nell are unexpectedly thrown back together for a gig. Unknown to them, the audience is just one man: Charles Heath, a wealthy and delightfully quirky recluse. Charles has used his considerable resources to orchestrate a private reunion of his favourite musicians at his home on a remote British island. The musical duo share a romantic and professional past, but haven't seen each other in years. This peculiar event forces them to confront old memories, unresolved regrets and long-dormant feelings. Tom Basden and Carey Mulligan as Herb and Nell share a subtle, lived-in chemistry, making their moments of tension and tenderness feel all the more authentic. As they reminisce and reconnect, the film gently unravels the emotional threads of their shared past.

As usual advance booking only – please book and pay for your tickets online at pay-brilley.co.uk Brilley and Michaelchurch Village Hall (HR3 6JG), doors open at 7pm - don't forget to bring your own refreshments!

Local Business Directory

If you contact the services of anyone advertised here,
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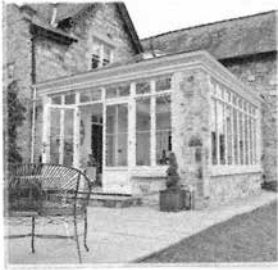
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Kington<> Knighton

	41	41	41	41	41	41
	M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
Kington Mill St	06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30
Titiley	06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39
Knighton Bus Station	06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05
Knighton Library		08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-

	41	41	41	41	41	41
	M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
Knighton Offa's Dyke	06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03
Knighton Bus Staion	06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07
Titiley	07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27
Kington Mill St	07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37

Knighton<> Leominster

	95	95
Tues and Fri only	T+F	T+F
Knighton Bus Staion	09:10	13:30
Kington Mill St	09:46	13:35
Leominster Bus Station	10:31	14:23
Leominster Bus Station	10:36	14:57

Knighton Bus Staion

Kington Mill St

Leominster Bus Station

Leominster Bus Station

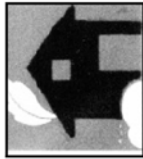
Leominster Bus Station

Leominster Bus Station

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Knighton Bus Staion

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Forthcoming events

<i>January</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Fri 2 nd <i>Repeated weekly</i>	10am - 12pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
Sun 4 th	6.00pm	Prayer & Praise Evening	St Mary's, Kington
Wed 7 th	7.00pm	The Bible Course (5)	Parish Hall
Mon 5 th <i>Repeated weekly</i>	12.30 – 4.00pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
Wed 14 th	7.00pm	The Bible Course (6)	Parish Hall
Sun 18 th	4.00pm	Plough Sunday	St Stephen's, Old Radnor
Wed 21 st	3.30pm	Lego Club	St Mary's, Kington
Wed 21 st	7.00pm	The Bible Course (7)	Parish Hall
Wed 28 th	7.00pm	The Bible Course (8)	Parish Hall
Sat 31 st	7.30pm	Discovering Scottish Churches (Richard Surman, photographer). 07791 935955	Parish Hall Tickets: £12

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 6

Plus plenty of Kington community events at The Oxford Arms, The Old Picture House, Kington Community Choir (Thursdays at The Burton).

You can also find details of many cultural events and activities in Broad Sheep: www.broadsheep.com

If you would like a community event publicised in the Diary please contact: Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

MATERIAL FOR THE FEBRUARY 2026 PARISH NEWS by 10th January 2026

Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:
pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Note: The cut-off date is always the 10th of the previous month